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To remove residual or overriding DNS servers on macOS, launch `sudo scutil`, locate the target network service key (e.g., `State:/Network/Service/PRIMARY_SERVICE_ID/DNS`), and delete the `ServerAddresses` key. This is commonly done when VPNs or applications leave behind stubborn DNS configs. [📘 Super User +4](#)

Run these steps in your terminal to remove and reset the resolvers: [📘 Super User +1](#)

bash

```
sudo scutil
```

Use code with caution.



Once in the interactive prompt (`>`), execute:

text

```
list State:/Network/Service/[0-9A-F]*/DNS
```

Use code with caution.



(Identify the specific service ID or your active VPN connection from the list). [🔗](#)

text

```
get State:/Network/Service/YOUR_SERVICE_ID/DNS
d.remove ServerAddresses
set State:/Network/Service/YOUR_SERVICE_ID/DNS
quit
```

Use code with caution.



Finally, flush your DNS cache and restart the system resolver by running: [🔗](#)

bash

```
sudo dscacheutil -flushcache; sudo killall -HUP mDNSResponder
```

Use code with caution.

If you tell me **what specific VPN or application** is causing the DNS issue, I can help find the **exact Service ID string** to target.

 3 sites

Change DNS Server From Terminal (or script) on Mac OS X

Dec 21, 2009 — Temporary DNS Changes with scutil: The `scutil` command can be used interactively from the terminal to change DNS settings, but th...



 Super User

VPN client over-riding DNS on macOS - rakhesh.com

Jan 19, 2019 — I just chose to over-ride both the SearchDomain and ServerAddresses with my local settings (thanks to this post and this): > d.rem...

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[https://apple.stackexchange.com › questions › broken-d...](https://apple.stackexchange.com/questions/broken-dns-resolvers-automatically-included-on-scutil--dns)

Broken DNS resolvers automatically included on scutil --dns

Feb 14, 2023 — **scutil --dns shows the correct resolvers**, without search domains. Removing it with `sudo "/Library/Application Support/ZeroTier/One/uninstall.sh ...`

[Remove custom dns server setting via command line ...](#) 2 answers Jan 13, 2020

[OpenVPN DNS resolving broken on MacOS Sonoma](#) 3 answers Dec 12, 2023

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Super User

<https://superuser.com> › questions › change-dns-server-f...

Change DNS Server From Terminal (or script) on Mac OS X

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[6 answers](#) · Top answer: You can use networksetup, e.g. for having the Airport connection use Google'...

[Change Primary DNS server from CLI/terminal ...](#) 1 answer Oct 26, 2022

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VPN client over-riding DNS on macOS

Jan 19, 2019 — I have moved to using GlobalProtect, and it works differently in that it overrides the default **resolvers** and makes the VPN provided ones the primary.



Reddit · r/MacOS

3 comments · 1 year ago

Change DNS resolver order : r/MacOS

You can force **DNS** on your connection under the System Settings-> Network -> network interface -> Details-> **DNS**.

[Stale DNS entry in "scutil --dns" how to delete?](#) 4 posts May 8, 2023

[MacOS Ventura DNS Resetting : r/fortinet](#) 8 posts Dec 2, 2022

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Google Groups

<https://groups.google.com> › tunnelblick-discuss

DNS resolution using pushed DNS-server doesn't work ...

Nov 3, 2022 — After connecting to VPN, at random (minutes after connection), the resolv.conf file is changed by OS to **remove** VPN **DNS** servers and put back ...



vninja.net

<https://vninja.net> › 2020/02/06 › macos-custom-dns-res...

macOS: Using Custom DNS Resolvers - vNinja.net

Feb 6, 2020 — Verify that the new **DNS** settings are in place by running **scutil --dns** and looking at the output for the entries added in step

Missing: **remove** | Show results with: [remove](#)



Pritunl

<https://forum.pritunl.com> › dns-settings-stay-after-disco...

DNS settings stay after disconnecting from WireGuard ...

Dec 4, 2023 — On MacOS, when the client is connected to the server in WireGuard mode and

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mikebian.co

<https://mikebian.co> › understanding-dns-requests-on-mac...

Understanding DNS Requests on macOS - Michael Bianco

Sep 24, 2024 — You can see the **DNS resolvers** assigned to a specific device using **scutil --dns** ...

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